

HiveForce Labs

# THREAT ADVISORY

 **ATTACK REPORT**

## **BERT Ransomware Quietly Gains Global Ground**

Date of Publication

June 23, 2025

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2025197

# Summary

**Active Since:** March 2025

**Malware:** Bert Ransomware

**Targeted Regions:** United States, Türkiye, Taiwan, Malaysia, Colombia, United Kingdom

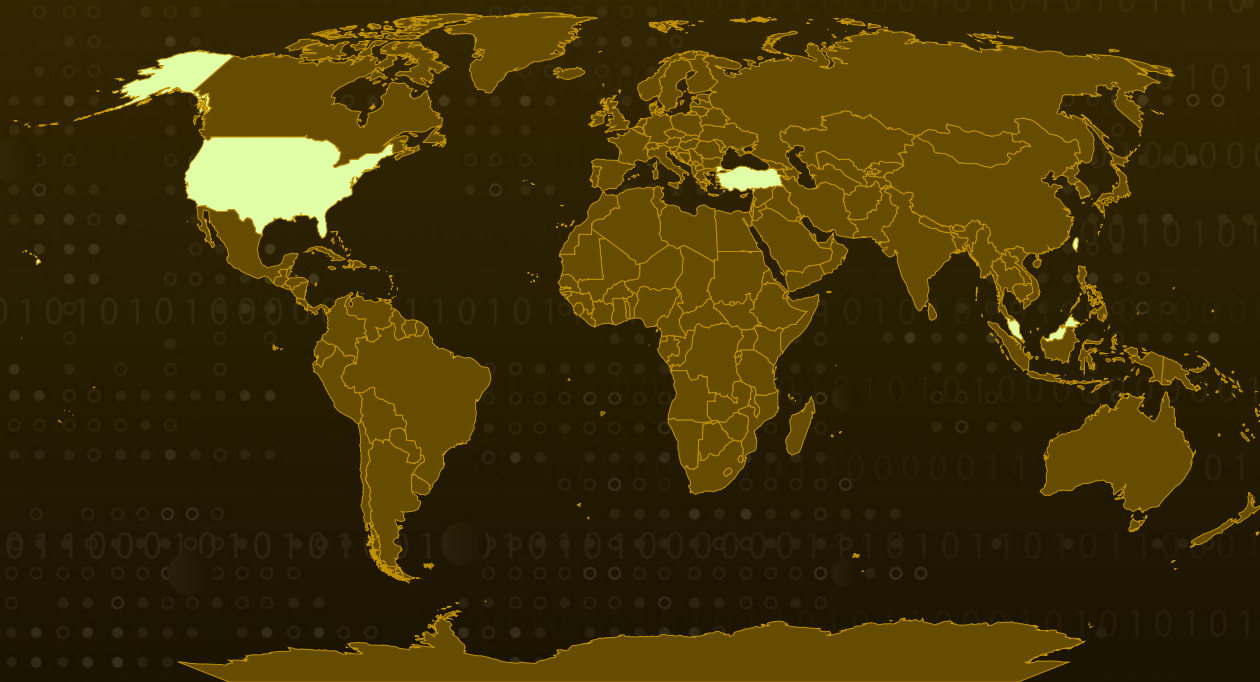
**Targeted Industries:** Transportation, Technology, Healthcare, Business Services, Manufacturing

**Targeted Platforms:** Windows and Linux

**Ransom:** 1.5 BTC (approximately \$152,000)

**Attack:** BERT ransomware, active since March 2025, has rapidly evolved into a multi-platform threat targeting systems across critical sectors. Leveraging REvil's code and demanding Bitcoin via the Session messenger, the campaign's growing operational footprint and double-extortion tactics signal a persistent and escalating threat landscape for global enterprises.

## Attack Regions



# Attack Details

#1

In mid-March 2025, a new ransomware strain known as BERT emerged in the wild. It allegedly claimed multiple victims across the Healthcare, Technology, and Transportation sectors in Türkiye, the United States, and the United Kingdom. The strain follows a typical double-extortion format.

#2

The ransomware initially targeted Windows environments, leveraging phishing emails containing malicious attachments or links as its primary infection vector. These emails typically deliver PowerShell-based loaders designed to evade security measures, escalate privileges, and deploy the ransomware payload.

#3

By May 2025, the threat actors behind BERT had expanded their operations to include Linux systems, employing custom ELF binaries while retaining the same phishing-based delivery approach. Notably, BERT's Linux variant shares approximately 80% of its codebase with REvil (Sodinokibi), one of the most notorious ransomware families to date.

#4

Once deployed, the ransomware encrypts files across the compromised network, appending extensions such as .encryptedbybert, .encryptedbybert3, or .hellofrombert to the affected files. It also drops a ransom note named note.txt into each directory containing encrypted data.

#5

Victims are instructed to contact the attackers via the privacy-centric Session messenger to negotiate a ransom payment, which is demanded exclusively in Bitcoin. BERT's activity has resulted in several high-profile incidents. In April 2025, SIMCO Electronics (USA) suffered a significant breach that disrupted manufacturing processes and exposed confidential internal data.

#6

The following month, All Ring Tech (Taiwan) was targeted by a ransomware attack that crippled logistics systems and halted shipment tracking. Most recently, in June 2025, the group claimed responsibility for stealing nearly 140 GB of sensitive information from S5 Agency World, a UK-based maritime logistics firm operating in over 360 ports worldwide.

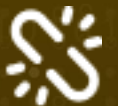
## Recommendations



**Strengthen Email Security and Phishing Defenses:** Enhance email gateway controls to detect and quarantine phishing emails carrying malicious attachments or links. Leverage advanced threat protection, sandboxing, and dynamic analysis tools to inspect attachments and URLs before delivery.



**Implement the 3-2-1 Backup Rule:** Maintain three total copies of your data, with two backups stored on different devices and one backup kept offsite or in the cloud. This ensures redundancy and protects against data loss from ransomware attacks.



**Backup & Recovery Preparedness:** Maintain offline, immutable, and regularly tested backups. Ensure recovery time objectives (RTOs) and recovery point objectives (RPOs) meet business continuity requirements in the event of ransomware deployment.



## Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

|                                                               |                                                              |                                                          |                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b><u>TA0001</u></b><br>Initial Access                        | <b><u>TA0002</u></b><br>Execution                            | <b><u>TA0003</u></b><br>Persistence                      | <b><u>TA0004</u></b><br>Privilege Escalation             |
| <b><u>TA0005</u></b><br>Defense Evasion                       | <b><u>TA0007</u></b><br>Discovery                            | <b><u>TA0009</u></b><br>Collection                       | <b><u>TA0011</u></b><br>Command and Control              |
| <b><u>TA0010</u></b><br>Exfiltration                          | <b><u>TA0040</u></b><br>Impact                               | <b><u>T1566</u></b><br>Phishing                          | <b><u>T1204</u></b><br>User Execution                    |
| <b><u>T1204.002</u></b><br>Malicious File                     | <b><u>T1059.001</u></b><br>PowerShell                        | <b><u>T1059</u></b><br>Command and Scripting Interpreter | <b><u>T1547</u></b><br>Boot or Logon Autostart Execution |
| <b><u>T1547.001</u></b><br>Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder | <b><u>T1543</u></b><br>Create or Modify System Process       | <b><u>T1543.003</u></b><br>Windows Service               | <b><u>T1548</u></b><br>Abuse Elevation Control Mechanism |
| <b><u>T1548.002</u></b><br>Bypass User Account Control        | <b><u>T1068</u></b><br>Exploitation for Privilege Escalation | <b><u>T1562</u></b><br>Impair Defenses                   | <b><u>T1562.001</u></b><br>Disable or Modify Tools       |
| <b><u>T1027</u></b><br>Obfuscated Files or Information        | <b><u>T1070.004</u></b><br>File Deletion                     | <b><u>T1070</u></b><br>Indicator Removal                 | <b><u>T1083</u></b><br>File and Directory Discovery      |
| <b><u>T1049</u></b><br>System Network Connections Discovery   | <b><u>T1005</u></b><br>Data from Local System                | <b><u>T1573</u></b><br>Encrypted Channel                 | <b><u>T1041</u></b><br>Exfiltration Over C2 Channel      |

|                                                         |                                                                |                                           |                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b><u>T1106</u></b><br>Native API                       | <b><u>T1053.005</u></b><br>Scheduled Task                      | <b><u>T1053</u></b><br>Scheduled Task/Job | <b><u>T1574</u></b><br>Hijack Execution Flow           |
| <b><u>T1574.001</u></b><br>DLL                          | <b><u>T1140</u></b><br>Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information | <b><u>T1070.006</u></b><br>Timestamp      | <b><u>T1497</u></b><br>Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion  |
| <b><u>T1564.001</u></b><br>Hidden Files and Directories | <b><u>T1564</u></b><br>Hide Artifacts                          | <b><u>T1055</u></b><br>Process Injection  | <b><u>T1082</u></b><br>System Information Discovery    |
| <b><u>T1071</u></b><br>Application Layer Protocol       | <b><u>T1056</u></b><br>Input Capture                           | <b><u>T1518</u></b><br>Software Discovery | <b><u>T1518.001</u></b><br>Security Software Discovery |
| <b><u>T1012</u></b><br>Query Registry                   | <b><u>T1057</u></b><br>Process Discovery                       | <b><u>T1087</u></b><br>Account Discovery  | <b><u>T1489</u></b><br>Service Stop                    |
| <b><u>T1486</u></b><br>Data Encrypted for Impact        | <b><u>T1490</u></b><br>Inhibit System Recovery                 | <b><u>T1491</u></b><br>Defacement         | <b><u>T1657</u></b><br>Financial Theft                 |

# ✂ Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

| TYPE        | VALUE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>URLs</b> | hxxp[:]//185[.]100[.]157[.]74/payload[.]exe,<br>hxxp[:]//169[.]254[.]169[.]254/latest/meta-data/ami-id,<br>hxxp[:]//185[.]100[.]157[.]74/start[.]ps1                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>IPv4</b> | 169[.]254[.]169[.]254,<br>185[.]100[.]157[.]74                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>MD5</b>  | 71dc9540eb03f2ed4d1b6496b13fe839,<br>00fdc504be1788231aa7b7d2d1335893,<br>d1013bbaa2f151195d563b2b65126fa3,<br>3e581aad42a2a9e080a4a676de42f015,<br>edec051ce461d62fbbd3abf09534b731,<br>5cab4fabffeb5903f684c936a90e0b46,<br>003291d904b89142bada57a9db732ae7,<br>29a2cc59a9ebd334103ce146bca38522,<br>38ce06bf89b28cceb5a78404eb3818e |



| TYPE        | VALUE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SHA256      | 8478d5f5a33850457abc89a99718fc871b80a8fb0f5b509ac1102f441189a311,<br>6182df9c60f9069094fb353c4b3294d13130a71f3e677566267d4419f281ef02,<br>ced4ed5e5ef7505dd008ed7dd28b8aff38df7febe073d990d6d74837408ea4be,<br>f2dc218ea8e2caa8668e54bae6561afd9fbf035a40b80ce9e847664ff0809799,<br>25c693808095f45d297171eba5196e9a5176281a2d248cb1a8cfa07a68bbe332,<br>78eb838238dad971dcbc46b86491d95e297f3d47dc770de5c43af3163990d31c,<br>5bba035c4cb3c2e09a355d9356b3397184af4bf1ac1ff1df99ae9c15edee9f2b,<br>c7efe9b84b8f48b71248d40143e759e6fc9c6b7177224eb69e0816cc2db393db,<br>b2f601ca68551c0669631fd5427e6992926ce164f8b3a25ae969c7f6c6ce8e4f |
| Filename    | note.txt                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| TOR Address | bertblogsoqmm4ow7nqyh5ik7etsmefdbf25stauecytvwy7tkgizhad[.]onion,<br>wtwdv3ss4d637dka7iafl7737ucykei7pluzc7is3mgo2vl5nmq7eeid[.]onion                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

## Recent Breaches

<https://s5agencyworld.com/>  
<https://columbiati.com.br/>  
<https://www.wawasandengkil.com/>  
<https://allring-tech.com.tw/>  
<https://www.simco.com/>  
<https://vozgatsehir.saglik.gov.tr/>  
<https://nationalticket.com/>

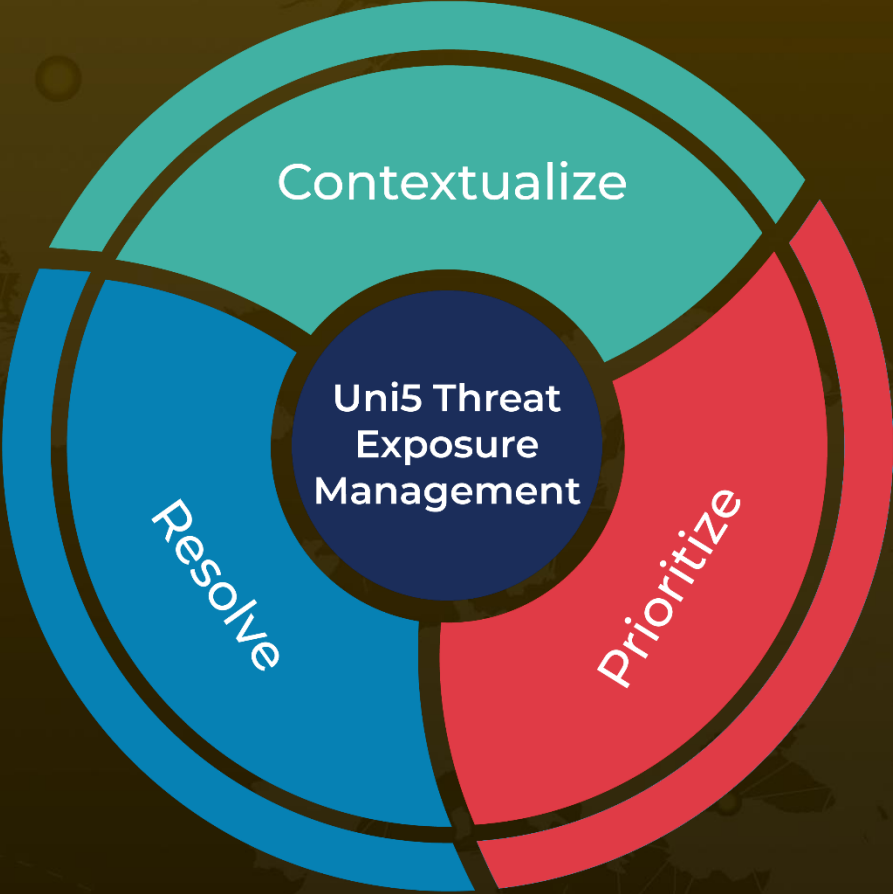
## References

<https://theravenfile.com/2025/06/16/bert-ransomware/>  
<https://www.broadcom.com/support/security-center/protection-bulletin/bert-ransomware>

# What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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